

HR-201 Attendance and Working Hours

Policy ID: HR-201 Version: 3.1 Classification: Internal
Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent and fixed-term employees

1 Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out the company's expectations for working hours and attendance. It explains the standard working week, how attendance is recorded, and what employees must do when they are unable to attend work.

The policy applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees. Contractors and agency workers follow the terms of their engagement, except where this policy is referenced in that agreement.

2 Working Hours

2.1 Standard Working Hours

The standard working week is thirty-seven and a half hours, worked Monday to Friday. Normal office hours are from nine in the morning until half past five in the afternoon, which includes an unpaid lunch break of one hour.

All employees are expected to be contactable and available for meetings during core hours, which run from ten in the morning until four in the afternoon. Outside core hours, employees may vary their start and finish times by up to one hour with their manager's agreement, provided the full weekly hours are worked and business needs are met.

Part-time employees work the hours set out in their contract of employment. Where a part-time pattern does not cover the full core hours, the manager and employee must agree in writing which hours are treated as core.

2.2 Rest Breaks

Employees are entitled to an uninterrupted rest break of at least twenty minutes when their working day exceeds six hours. Rest breaks are unpaid and should be taken away from the workstation.

2.3 Overtime

Overtime must be approved in advance by the employee's manager. Approved overtime is compensated as time off in lieu, to be taken within three months. Time off in lieu that is not taken within that period lapses.

3 Attendance

3.1 Attendance Expectations

Employees are expected to attend work punctually and to be present for all scheduled hours. Attendance is recorded in the human resources system, and employees are responsible for ensuring their own record is accurate at the end of each week.

An employee who is unable to attend work must notify their manager directly, by telephone or by a message the manager will see, no later than half past nine on the first day of absence. A message left with a colleague is not sufficient notice. The employee must state the reason for the absence and the expected date of return, and must update their manager daily thereafter unless a longer absence has been agreed.

Absence of more than seven consecutive calendar days must be supported by a fit note from a medical practitioner. Absence of seven days or fewer requires a completed self-certification form, submitted on

the first day back at work.

3.2 Unauthorised Absence

Absence that has not been notified or authorised is treated as unauthorised and is unpaid. Repeated unauthorised absence may be dealt with under the disciplinary procedure. Two consecutive working days of unauthorised absence with no contact will trigger a formal welfare check by People Operations.

3.3 Lateness

Occasional lateness caused by circumstances outside the employee's control will not be penalised, provided the manager is informed. Persistent lateness, defined as arriving after the agreed start time on more than four occasions in any rolling month, will be addressed in the first instance through an informal discussion with the manager.

4 Recording Time

Employees record working time, leave, and absence in the human resources system. Managers review their team's records monthly and confirm them before payroll closes. Deliberately false time records are treated as gross misconduct.

5 Related Policies

- Annual Leave, reference HR-202
- Flexible Working, reference HR-204
- Remote and Hybrid Working, reference HR-207